

YANG, XUETING

Department of Economics and Related Studies, University of York, York, YO10 5DD

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EDUCATION

09/2023 – 2027 (Expected) University of York, Department of Economics and Related Studies York, UK

Ph.D., Economics

Dissertation: *Individual decision-making in ambiguous (and risky) situations*

Expected thesis submission: November 2026

09/2020 – 03/2022 Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou Suzhou, China

MSc, Economics and Finance (with Distinction)

09/2015 – 07/2019 Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou Suzhou, China

BSc, Economics and Finance (with First-class Honours)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Experimental and Behavioural Economics, with a focus on decision-making under risk and ambiguity, consumer behaviour, and applied microeconomic theory.

PUBLICATIONS & PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

- Yang, X., & Hey, J. (2025). **Do workers maximize expected utility when choosing labour contracts under ambiguity?** *Journal of Risk and Uncertainty*, 71(3), 273–292. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11166-025-09470-w>
- Yang, X. (2026). **“Less Is More”: Decision-Making under Increasingly Complex Ambiguity** (*Accepted, Journal of Risk and Uncertainty – Job Market Paper*)

Examines whether increasingly complex decisions under ambiguity require more parameterized behavioural models. Using a laboratory allocation experiment and individual-level model comparison, the paper compares Expected Utility (EU), α MaxMin (AMM), and Choquet Expected Utility (CEU) across ambiguous choice environments of increasing structural complexity. EU is most frequently selected by AICc across all three ambiguous-lottery tasks, although its relative advantage varies across tasks and CEU remains competitive in the most complex setting.

- Yang, X. (2026). **Probability Misperception in Blind Box Consumption: An Experimental Investigation of Risk and Ambiguity Preferences** (*Major Revisions, Theory and Decision*)

Uses laboratory experiments (BDM mechanism) to test whether consumers overestimate low-probability outcomes. Results show systematic overestimation, particularly among risk-seeking individuals, suggesting that probability misperception may help explain demand for blind boxes.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Cognitive Ability and Belief Formation under Ambiguity

Examines how cognitive ability shapes the precision and calibration of subjective beliefs under ambiguity, using incentivised laboratory experiments and measures of risk and ambiguity preferences.

AWARDS & FUNDING

- *Departmental PhD Studentship Funding*, University of York, 2023-2027
- *2025-2026 Award for Outstanding Overseas Study Elite*, China Scholarship Council, 2026
- *Teaching Excellence Award*, University of York, 2025

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

- 06/2026 *ASFEE 2026: Annual Conference of the French Association of Experimental Economics*, Lille, France. (Oral Presentation)
- 06/2026 *2026 CMID (conference on Mechanism and Institution Design)*, York, UK. (Member of local organization committee)
- 06/2026 *FUR (Foundations of Utility and Risk) Conference 2026*, Alicante, Spain. (Oral Presentation)
- 05/2026 *2026 Durham-Edinburgh-York Workshop*, Durham, UK. (Oral Presentation)
- 03/2026 *ECO Department Brownbag Seminar*, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, Suzhou, China. (Presenter)
- 10/2025 *Departmental Thursday Workshop*, University of York, York, UK. (Presenter)
- 06/2025 *ASFEE 2025: 15th Conference of the French Experimental Economics Association*, Nancy, France. (Oral Presentation & Poster session)
- 06/2025 *ESA 2025 World Meeting*, Beijing, China. (Oral Presentation)
- 08/2024 *2024 SABE/IAREP Conference*, Dundee, UK. (Poster Session)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of York, Department of Economics and Related Studies

York, UK

Teaching Assistant

Microeconomic Theory (Undergraduate), 09/2024 – 02/2026

- Led tutorials on core microeconomic concepts and problem-solving; supported students' analytical and mathematical reasoning and provided feedback on assessed work.

Probability and Statistics (Undergraduate), 02/2025 – 06/2025

- Delivered small-group tutorials on probability and statistical methods, guiding students in applying theoretical concepts to practical problems.

Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou

Suzhou, China

Teaching Assistant

Experimental Economics and Finance (Undergraduate), 09/2021 – 12/2021

- Supported classroom experiments by explaining procedures and economic concepts, facilitating discussions, and guiding students in interpreting experimental outcomes.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGE

- **Software & Programming**
 - **Experimental programming:** Visual Studio (C#/.NET), z-Tree; developed custom Windows Forms applications for risk/ambiguity elicitation, BDM mechanisms, and complexity treatments.
 - **Quantitative analysis:** MATLAB, R, STATA; behavioural data analysis and econometric modelling.
- **Languages** Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (basic), Thai (beginner)

REFERENCES

Professor John Hey

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